Cuba sent some 30,000 health workers abroad, including 10,000 physicians. In 1984, Castro announced an initiative to train 10,000 new doctors specifically to enhance its program of medical aid. At the end of 2005, Cuba had medical missions in 68 countries.[33] Cubans made up the largest contingent of doctors rushed to Kashmir after the 2005 earthquake. Over 300 Cuban doctors were already working in Haiti when the earthquake devastated Port au Prince in early 2010, and more were quickly flown in. "It doesn't matter if things seem impossible," one of them told the *Miami Herald*. "One has to keep up the fight."[34]

Cuba also implemented a massive training program for health professionals from the Third World – all provided free of cost to participants. Between 1961 and 2001, some 40,000 students, primarily from Asia and Africa, traveled to Cuba for training. In 1998, Cuba established the Latin American Medical School (Escuela Latino-Americana de Medicina, or ELAM) specifically for African and Latin American students. In exchange for full scholarships, students agree to serve for five years in underserved communities in their homelands. In 2005–6, there were over 10,000 students enrolled in the school, from 27 countries.[35]

"Rather than a fifth column promoting socialist ideology," Julie Feinsilver argues, "these doctors provide a serious threat to the status quo by their example of serving the poor in areas in which no local doctor would work, by making house calls a routine part of their medical practice and by being available free of charge 24/7, thus changing the nature of doctor–patient relations. As a result, they have forced the re-examination of societal values and the structure and functioning of the health systems and the medical profession within the countries to which they were sent and where they continue to practice. This is the current Cuban threat."[36]

If, as Van Gosse argued, the Cuban Revolution offered the world an example of a revolution that could break with Soviet dogmas, and so opened up the possibility for a whole new way of imagining revolutionary change, the Sandinistas were perhaps the first successful revolution to flourish from the seeds it planted. The New Left in the